

Assessment Book — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Questions

Total marks 98

Q1. (6 marks) Using the document, analyse and list the multiple long-term and short-term social, economic, financial and political factors it identifies as causes of the French Revolution. For each factor you name, cite the specific evidence from the document and give a brief sentence explaining how that factor contributed. (6 marks)

Q2. (3 marks) Explain the sequence of events by which the Estates General of 1789 led to the Third Estate declaring itself the National Assembly. In your answer, give the specific dated actions from the period that show this development.

Q3. (1 mark) Which interpretation best applies the evidence about the scale and mechanisms of repression during the Reign of Terror, and about how that period ended with Thermidor?

- A. The Terror was a centrally organised campaign uniformly supported by all revolutionary leaders, carrying out consistent mass executions that left little dispute about the numbers arrested or killed.
- B. The Terror combined large-scale, state-led arrests and executions (about 300,000 arrests and roughly 16,600 judicial executions) with contested estimates and episodes of localised violence (for example drownings at Nantes); it ended when Robespierre lost support, was arrested, wounded after an attempted suicide, and executed on 28 July 1794.
- C. Repression during the Terror was mainly spontaneous popular vengeance rather than state action, so historians treat the arrests and executions as largely unofficial and outside central control; Robespierre remained widely popular and died accidentally during unrest in late July.
- D. Most historians now agree the death toll of the Terror was vastly higher than early counts and that Thermidor did not involve a clear change of leadership, since Robespierre escaped arrest and went into exile instead of being executed.

Q4. (6 marks) Describe the measures taken by the National Assembly against the Catholic Church between 1789 and 1790 (confiscation of property, abolition of tithes, and the Civil Constitution of the Clergy). Then explain one social consequence the document attributes to these measures. Your answer should be focused and supported by the ideas in the text.

Q5. (3 marks) Using passages from the document, explain how newspapers and pamphlets influenced public debate during the Revolution and identify one example given in the text. (3 marks)

Q6. (1 mark) Which description best captures the core timeframe and long-term impact of the French Revolution?

- A. A brief 1789 uprising confined to Paris that quickly restored the king and left little lasting change.
- B. A decade-long period from the Estates General in 1789 to the Coup of 18 Brumaire in 1799 characterized by major political and social upheaval that weakened monarchical authority and promoted ideas (liberty, equality, citizenship) which influenced later liberal democracy and French political values.
- C. The era of Napoleon (about 1804–1815) when military conquest spread revolutionary institutions and ended the Revolution by establishing a stable imperial monarchy.
- D. A widespread peasant revolt in the 1770s that immediately produced democratic constitutions across France and Europe.

Q7. (6 marks) Explain why the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789 became an important symbol of the French Revolution. In your answer, include what the Bastille represented, what actually happened there on the day (including a correct statement about prisoners), and one immediate consequence in the weeks after. (6 marks)

Q8. (3 marks) In two or three sentences, explain what the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen was and why the National Assembly issued it during the French Revolution.

Q9. (1 mark) Which event most directly caused the suspension of the French monarchy and led to the proclamation of the First French Republic in 1792?

- A. The storming of the Bastille in July 1789, which sparked the revolutionary wave
- B. The insurrection of 10 August 1792, when revolutionaries attacked the Tuileries and forced the king's suspension
- C. The execution of Louis XVI in January 1793, which completed the end of the monarchy
- D. The establishment of the Directory in 1795, which reorganised French government after the revolution

Q10. (6 marks) Explain what the Law of 22 Prairial (10 June 1794) changed about criminal procedure during the Terror and how those changes accelerated executions in Paris. In your answer, give specific features of the law and at least one piece of contextual evidence or interpretation to show why these features produced more rapid executions. (6 marks)

Q11. (3 marks) Explain two contrasting outcomes of the Thermidorian Reaction and its immediate aftermath in France — one describing what happened in the regions (social/violent response) and one describing how political control changed in Paris and nationally. Be specific and show the contrast.

Q12. (1 mark) Which feature best describes the government set up by the Constitution of Year III (1795)?

- A. A bicameral legislature (Council of 500 and Council of Ancients) and a five-member Directory that ruled through indirect elections and property qualifications
- B. A single, powerful executive leader with emergency powers and direct popular elections for all offices
- C. Universal male suffrage with frequent referendums and a small appointed council to carry out laws
- D. An assembly dominated by sans-culottes committees with local councils selecting an executive committee of three

Q13. (6 marks) Explain how the Revolutionary Wars (from 1792) both mobilised mass armies and expanded into multiple theatres, and show how this mobilisation helped lead to annexations and the creation of satellite states. Give at least two specific examples to support your explanation.

Q14. (3 marks) Explain why the National Convention abolished slavery in the French colonies on 4 February 1794 and state the main change this decision made for people of colour. (3 marks)

Q15. (1 mark) How did the French Revolution affect women's political role by 1793?

- A. Women played no part in early revolutionary activism and were excluded from political societies from the beginning of the Revolution.
- B. Women were active in early activism and organised societies, but the 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied them political rights and women's clubs were banned in October 1793.
- C. Women won full political rights under the 1791 constitution and continued to expand legal club activity after 1793.
- D. Although women could not hold national office, the 1793 reforms officially recognised their right to vote and participate in local government.

Q16. (6 marks) Explain how the Revolutionary government's economic policies led to the creation and collapse of the assignats, and assess the consequences of this collapse for the French economy and society. In your answer, use evidence from the historical record and show at least one competing interpretation of why the assignats failed. (6 marks)

Q17. (3 marks) Using the cited Britannica article, explain two main causes of the French Revolution and briefly describe how each contributed to the outbreak of revolution. (3 marks)

Q18. (6 marks) The text lists "Guillotine (Opie 1997)" as a cited source. Explain in your own words what this citation tells a reader about the source, and describe two ways a historian might use this citation when researching the history of the guillotine. Your answer should show you understand the nature of the citation and give concrete examples of how it could be used as evidence or a research lead.

Q19. (3 marks) According to Acemoglu, Cantoni, Johnson & Robinson (2011), what were two key long-term economic consequences of the French Revolution's radical reforms? Briefly describe one piece of evidence the authors use to support their claims. (3 marks)

Q20. (6 marks) Using Harvey Chisick's work on pamphlets and journalism in the early French Revolution (including the offices of the Ami du Roi of the Abbé Royou), explain how royalist pamphlets and periodicals attempted to influence public opinion in 1789–1791. In your answer, identify at least two methods these publications used and one limitation or challenge they faced.

Q21. (6 marks) Using the compiled scholarly bibliography on the French Revolution, identify two major historiographical themes that the bibliography represents. For each theme, name one work (author and title) from the list that exemplifies it and explain, with reference to the work's focus or methods, how it fits that theme. Your answer should show understanding of the differing interpretive approaches in the bibliography. (6 marks)

Q22. (6 marks) Using the document, analyse and list the multiple long-term and short-term social, economic, financial and political causes of the French Revolution. For each cause you identify, cite the specific evidence from the document and say briefly whether it was a long-term or short-term cause. (6 marks)

Q23. (6 marks) Explain the sequence of events by which the Estates General of 1789 led to the Third Estate declaring itself the National Assembly. In your answer use specific dated actions between May and June 1789 and explain how each action caused the next (6 marks).

Q24. (6 marks) Using the evidence provided, analyse the scale and mechanisms of repression during the Reign of Terror (Sept 1793–July 1794) and evaluate two differing historical interpretations of why the Terror occurred. In your answer refer to the scale of arrests and executions, the forms of repression (including controversial events such as the drownings at Nantes), and the political consequences culminating in Thermidor and the execution of Robespierre. (6 marks)

Answer Key

Q1.

Answer: 1) Population growth (social, long-term). Evidence: the document lists “population growth.” Analysis: rising population increased pressure on land and food supplies and raised demand for goods, intensifying social strain and competition for resources.

2) Economic recession and bad harvests (economic, short- to medium-term). Evidence: the document names “economic recession” and “bad harvests.” Analysis: poor harvests reduced grain supply and pushed up bread prices, while recession lowered incomes, together causing urban and rural hardship that fuelled unrest.

3) Tax complexity and unequal taxation (financial/economic, long-term). Evidence: the document refers to “tax complexity” and the tax system. Analysis: a cumbersome, unfair tax system left the privileged exempt or lightly taxed and placed heavy burdens on peasants and the bourgeoisie, creating widespread resentment.

4) Financial crisis/state debt (financial, short-term). Evidence: the document cites “financial” problems and resistance to fiscal reform. Analysis: large royal debt and repeated fiscal crises made government unable to govern effectively and forced attempts at reform that met opposition, triggering political crisis.

5) Resistance to reform by elites (political, short- to medium-term). Evidence: the document mentions “resistance to reform.” Analysis: when ministers or the king tried to introduce necessary fiscal and administrative reforms, privileged groups (e.g., parlements, nobility) blocked them, undermining the monarchy’s legitimacy and provoking confrontation.

6) Enlightenment ideas (political/social, long-term). Evidence: the document lists “Enlightenment ideas.” Analysis: spread of ideas about rights, representation and criticism of absolute monarchy changed public opinion, provided ideological tools for critics, and helped convert social and economic grievances into demands for political change.

Rubric — Extent and quality of analysis: identification of multiple long-term and short-term social, economic, financial and political causes supported by specific evidence from the document and brief explanation of causal effect.

Excellent (6 marks): Identifies at least six distinct causes that cover social, economic, financial and political categories and both long- and short-term factors; for each factor quotes or names the specific evidence from the document and gives a clear, concise sentence explaining how that factor contributed to the Revolution.

Partial (3 marks): Identifies 3–4 relevant causes with some coverage across the required categories; cites specific evidence from the document for most listed factors and gives brief but sometimes incomplete explanations of how they contributed.

Minimal or Incorrect (0 marks): Identifies one or two vague or unsupported causes, fails to cite specific evidence from the document, or gives explanations that do not connect the factor to how it caused the Revolution.

Q2.

Answer: The Estates General was convened on 5 May 1789. Over the following weeks the Third Estate, frustrated by disputes over voting and representation in the Estates General, broke with the other orders. In June 1789 the Third Estate reconstituted itself as the National Assembly (commonly dated to mid-June 1789), asserting that it represented the nation and claiming the right to make laws. Thus the calling of the Estates General on 5 May led, through the political conflict of May–June, to the Third Estate declaring itself the National Assembly in June 1789.

Rubric — Shows the chronological link between the 5 May 1789 Estates General and the Third Estate's June 1789 declaration of the National Assembly, using dated actions and a causal explanation.

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly states that the Estates General opened on 5 May 1789 and explains that, after disputes over voting/representation, the Third Estate broke away and reconstituted itself as the National Assembly in June 1789; gives both dated actions and a causal link between them.

Partial credit (1 marks): Mentions one correct dated action (either 5 May 1789 or June 1789) and either describes the break by the Third Estate or gives a basic causal statement, but misses either one of the key dates or the clear causal link.

No credit (0 marks): Fails to give the correct dated actions (5 May 1789 and June 1789) or gives an answer that is historically incorrect or irrelevant to the sequence asked for.

Q3.

Correct: B. The Terror combined large-scale, state-led arrests and executions (about 300,000 arrests and roughly 16,600 judicial executions) with contested estimates and episodes of localised violence (for example drownings at Nantes); it ended when Robespierre lost support, was arrested, wounded after an attempted suicide, and executed on 28 July 1794.

A. Incorrect: This choice reflects the common misconception that all revolutionaries uniformly supported mass repression and that the figures were undisputed. The document shows the Terror involved organised arrests and executions but also contested death tolls and internal political conflict.

B. Correct: This option matches the documented evidence: around 300,000 arrests and about 16,600 executions, acknowledged episodes of locally violent methods such as the drownings at Nantes and contested estimates, and the fall of Robespierre—arrest, injury after an attempted suicide, and execution on 28 July 1794.

C. Incorrect: This answer overstates the idea that repression was mainly spontaneous popular violence and understates the role of state institutions and recorded judicial executions; it also wrongly claims Robespierre remained popular and did not die in July 1794.

D. Incorrect: This distractor misstates the historical record by claiming consensus on much higher death tolls and that Robespierre escaped arrest and exile. The document records his arrest and execution on 28 July 1794.

Q4.

Answer: Between 1789 and July 1790 the Assembly took several decisive measures against the Catholic Church. First, it confiscated church property: national lands belonging to the Church were seized and declared biens nationaux to be sold to raise revenue for the state. Second, it abolished tithes, ending the compulsory money or produce payments that peasants had paid to support the clergy. Third, on 12 July 1790 the Assembly passed the Civil Constitution of the Clergy, which made clergy employees of the state: priests and bishops were to be elected, paid by the government, and required to swear an oath of loyalty to the nation. These actions were part of a broader programme (reflected in the August Decrees) that also abolished feudal privileges, asserted equality before the law, and opened public offices to all citizens. The document attributes a clear social consequence to these measures: they produced division and resistance among clergy and many Catholics. Making priests state officials and eliminating tithes undermined the traditional independence and authority of the Church and forced many clergy either to accept the new order

or to refuse the oath. This split created a large group of “refractory” priests and alienated devout peasants and urban Catholics, contributing to social unrest, local protests, and in some regions to counter-revolutionary activity. In short, while the measures aimed at secularising Church wealth and bringing religion under state control, the immediate social consequence documented was a deepening of social and political divisions centred on faith and loyalty.

Rubric — Extent and accuracy of description of measures against the Church, and quality of explanation of one social consequence attributed to them.

6 marks (6 marks): Clearly and accurately describes the key measures: confiscation of Church property (*biens nationaux*), abolition of tithes, and the Civil Constitution of the Clergy (including that clergy became state employees/elected/paid and required oath). Also situates these within related measures (abolition of feudalism/August Decrees or equality before law) and gives a well-explained social consequence drawn from the document — that these measures caused division and resistance among clergy and many Catholics, with brief explanation of how this produced unrest or ‘refractory’ priests. All points are linked and supported by the text.

3 marks (3 marks): Describes two of the main measures correctly (for example confiscation of property and abolition of tithes, or Civil Constitution plus one other) and states a plausible social consequence (e.g. division/resistance) but explanation is limited, lacks linkage to how the measures produced resistance, or misses the wider context (August Decrees/abolition of feudalism).

0 marks (0 marks): Fails to describe the specified measures accurately (confuses actions or omits key measures) or gives an irrelevant or unsupported consequence; answer shows little or no understanding of the document’s claims.

Q5.

Answer: The document says newspapers and pamphlets proliferated during the Revolution, becoming the main medium of communication and stimulating revolutionary debate by spreading ideas and reporting events to a wide audience. For example, the text identifies the guillotine as a powerful revolutionary symbol — it became the principal symbol of the Terror and entered popular culture — showing how printed discussion helped shape public perception and debate about revolutionary justice.

Rubric — Use of the document to explain the influence of newspapers/pamphlets on public debate and identification of one example from the text.

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly explains that newspapers and pamphlets proliferated and became the main medium that stimulated revolutionary debate, and identifies one correct example from the text (e.g., the guillotine or *La Marseillaise*) with a brief link showing how that example reflects influence on public debate.

Partial credit (2 marks): Gives a limited explanation — mentions either the role of newspapers/pamphlets or names one correct example from the text, but misses either the connection to how they shaped public debate or does not use the document passages to support the point.

No credit (0 marks): Fails to explain how newspapers/pamphlets influenced public debate and does not identify a correct example from the text, or answer is off-topic or unsupported by the document.

Q6.

Correct: B. A decade-long period from the Estates General in 1789 to the Coup of 18 Brumaire in 1799 characterized by major political and social upheaval that weakened monarchical authority and promoted ideas (liberty, equality, citizenship) which influenced later liberal democracy and French political values.

A. Incorrect — treats the Revolution as a short, local disturbance that restored the king; misunderstands both duration (1789–1799) and its lasting political and ideological effects.

B. Correct — identifies the conventional core timeframe (1789 to 1799), notes major political and social change, and

links those changes to lasting contributions to liberal-democratic ideas and French political culture.

C. Incorrect — confuses the Revolutionary decade with the later Napoleonic period. Napoleon exported some institutions, but his rule (and imperial aims) did not simply 'end' the Revolution in the sense of its political and social consequences.

D. Incorrect — mistakes the Revolution for an earlier local peasant revolt and overstates an immediate, uniform outcome; the Revolution involved urban and elite political events as well as rural unrest, and its institutional changes unfolded over years.

Q7.

Answer: The Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789 became a lasting symbol of the French Revolution because the Bastille embodied royal authority, arbitrary power and the injustices of the Ancien Régime. Parisians attacked it to seize arms and gunpowder and to protest rising food prices and fears of a royal crackdown. Although the Bastille was popularly remembered as a large political prison, in reality it held very few prisoners at the time (only a handful, often reported as seven or fewer), so its importance was mainly symbolic rather than the liberation of many detainees. In the weeks after the attack the fortress was dismantled and its stones were distributed or displayed, reinforcing its role as a destroyed symbol of tyranny; the event also encouraged further revolutionary actions and helped spread unrest across France. Some historians stress its symbolic value and the power of public ritual, while others emphasise the practical motives (securing weapons) and the event's role in accelerating local insurrections and political change.

Rubric — Explanation of symbolism, description of what happened (including correct note on prisoner numbers), and an immediate consequence in the weeks after

Level 3 (6 marks): Provides the date (14 July 1789) and explains that the Bastille symbolised royal/arbitrary authority; correctly states that only a very small number of prisoners were held there at the time (not many political prisoners); describes the immediate consequence that the Bastille was demolished/dismantled in the following weeks and links this to its symbolic effect and spread of unrest. Includes either a brief mention of practical motives (seeking arms) or acknowledges competing interpretations. (Full, specific points addressing all parts.)

Level 2 (3 marks): Identifies the Bastille as a symbol of the Ancien Régime and gives a reasonable account of the attack (e.g., crowd seeking arms or protesting royal power) and an immediate consequence (demolition or increased unrest), but is incomplete or imprecise about prisoner numbers (vague or unclear) or fails to link consequences back to the Bastille's symbolic importance. May lack mention of competing interpretations. (Partial but accurate response.)

Level 1 (0 marks): Gives only minimal or inaccurate information: for example, states the Bastille was stormed but repeats the misconception that it held many political prisoners without correction, or mentions unrelated facts without explaining symbolism or consequences. Response shows limited understanding of the event's significance.

Q8.

Answer: The Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen (1789) was a statement produced by the National Assembly that set out fundamental individual rights and political principles—such as liberty, equality before the law, property, and the sovereignty of the people. The National Assembly issued it to replace the old privileges of the Ancien Régime, to limit the king's power, and to provide a clear set of principles for a new constitutional order influenced by Enlightenment ideas.

Rubric — Understanding of what the Declaration was and why the National Assembly issued it

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly identifies the Declaration as the 1789 statement of fundamental rights issued by the National Assembly and explains both its content (at least one clear example of rights/principles such as liberty,

equality, property, popular sovereignty) and its purpose (to limit royal power/replace Ancien Régime privileges and provide principles for a new government).

Partial credit (2 marks): Identifies the Declaration correctly and gives either a correct description of its content (e.g. lists rights) or a correct explanation of its purpose (e.g. to limit the king or end privileges), but not both or with only vague explanation.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Shows limited understanding: mentions either the National Assembly or that it concerned rights/political change but gives no accurate or clear explanation of content or purpose.

Q9.

Correct: B. The insurrection of 10 August 1792, when revolutionaries attacked the Tuileries and forced the king's suspension

A. This option mistakes an earlier, pivotal revolutionary event (the Bastille, 1789) for the direct cause; the Bastille sparked the revolution but did not by itself suspend the monarchy in 1792.

B. Correct — the insurrection of 10 August 1792 involved an attack on the Tuileries, the arrest and suspension of the king, and directly led to the proclamation of the First French Republic a month later.

C. This reverses cause and effect: Louis XVI's execution in January 1793 followed the suspension and abolition of the monarchy; it did not cause the 1792 suspension.

D. The Directory was created in 1795 as a later government after the revolution; it came after the republic was proclaimed and did not cause the 1792 suspension of the monarchy.

Q10.

Answer: The Law of 22 Prairial drastically reduced legal protections for the accused and so made trials much faster and far more deadly. Specifically, it removed the right of defendants to call witnesses or have counsel, limited the possible verdicts essentially to "acquittal" or "guilty" with no nuanced judgments, and allowed the Revolutionary Tribunal to convict on moral evidence or general suspicion rather than detailed proof. Procedural safeguards such as examination of evidence and the hearing of defence arguments were curtailed, and trials were shortened so that verdicts and executions followed quickly. Contextually, this law was passed when the Committee of Public Safety sought to speed up the processing of suspected "enemies of the people": historians note that after the law was enacted the number of people sent from Paris to the guillotine rose sharply, because the Tribunal could try many more cases in a short time and convict on vague charges. Some historians interpret the law as a deliberate move by revolutionary leaders to concentrate power and remove obstacles to mass repression; others argue it was an emergency response to perceived internal threats. Either way, by removing defence rights and simplifying verdicts the law materially accelerated executions in Paris.

Rubric — Explains the procedural changes introduced by the Law of 22 Prairial and links them to an increase in execution rate, using specific features and contextual evidence or interpretation.

Full (6 marks) (6 marks): Clearly names the key procedural changes (no counsel/witnesses, restricted verdicts, conviction on moral suspicion), explains how each change shortened trials or lowered the burden of proof, and links these changes to increased executions with at least one piece of contextual evidence or a competing interpretation (e.g. Committee of Public Safety intent, rise in convictions after June 1794).

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): Identifies one or two important changes (for example: removal of defence counsel or limited verdicts) and gives a plausible explanation of how they could speed up trials or increase convictions, but provides limited or no contextual evidence or interpretation.

Insufficient (0 marks) (0 marks): Makes only vague or incorrect statements about the law or fails to connect procedural changes to the acceleration of executions; little or no accurate detail provided.

Q11.

Answer: After Robespierre's fall the Thermidorian Reaction produced contrasting outcomes. Regionally, there were violent reprisals against Jacobins: in parts of southern France revenge killings and local uprisings targeted known supporters of the Terror, producing a wave of partisan violence. Politically, however, national control shifted without a complete purge of all Revolutionary officials: many former Terror figures managed to keep or regain positions as the Convention and committees reasserted moderate control, and power moved toward more conservative and property-owning groups rather than a full return to pre-Revolution institutions. Thus the aftermath combined local vengeance and violence with a political reorientation and selective survival of some former Terror actors.

Rubric — Shows understanding by identifying one regional/social outcome and one political outcome and explaining the contrast between them.

Full marks (3 marks): Clearly identifies both a regional/social outcome (e.g. revenge killings in southern France) and a political outcome (e.g. shift of control toward moderates while some former Terror figures retained positions), and explains how these two outcomes contrast.

Partial credit (2 marks): Identifies both outcomes but gives only brief or incomplete explanation of the contrast (e.g. names revenge killings and a political shift but does not show how they differ or omits that some former Terror figures survived).

Minimal credit (1 marks): Identifies only one correct outcome (either the regional violence or the political shift/survival of some Terror figures) or mentions both very vaguely without accurate detail or contrast.

No credit (0 marks): Response is incorrect, irrelevant, or blank; does not identify the required regional and political outcomes.

Q12.

Correct: A. A bicameral legislature (Council of 500 and Council of Ancients) and a five-member Directory that ruled through indirect elections and property qualifications

A. Correct — the Year III constitution created a two-chamber legislature (Council of 500 and Council of Ancients) and a five-director executive; it limited democracy by using indirect elections and property or age qualifications for office.

B. Wrong — this describes a strong, directly elected single executive, which conflicts with the Directory's design to avoid concentrating power and with its indirect election procedures.

C. Wrong — the Directory limited popular participation; it did not create universal male suffrage with frequent referendums, and it relied on indirect election methods and property/age qualifications rather than broad direct democracy.

D. Wrong — sans-culottes and local revolutionary committees had been weakened by 1795; the Constitution of Year III moved away from rule by popular revolutionary committees and did not establish a three-member executive chosen by local councils.

Q13.

Answer: The Revolutionary Wars transformed French warfare by mobilising large citizen armies and by spreading conflict across Europe and beyond, which in turn enabled France to annex territory and set up satellite states. Mobilisation: after 1792 the French government raised huge forces through measures such as the levée en masse (1793) and broader conscription policies, producing armies far larger than the professional forces of earlier wars. These mass armies provided the manpower to sustain long campaigns and replace losses, changing the scale of operations. Multiple theatres: France fought on many fronts — northern Europe and the Low Countries, the Rhine frontier and German states, Italy (notably Napoleon's campaigns 1796–97),

Spain and Portugal, and even overseas expeditions such as Egypt (1798). Examples of annexation and satellites: in 1795 the Dutch Republic was replaced by the Batavian Republic under French influence; in Italy Napoleon's victories led to the creation of the Cisalpine Republic (1797) and other sister republics; the French also annexed territories on the left bank of the Rhine and made territorial gains after treaties such as Campo Formio (1797). Causation: the large conscript armies made it possible to fight simultaneously in multiple theatres and to garrison occupied regions, enabling France to impose political changes and administrative control. Interpretations differ: some historians stress ideological aims (spreading revolutionary institutions), while others emphasise strategic and economic motives (securing buffers and resources). Both factors operated together: military capacity created by mobilisation gave France the means to export revolution or to secure its borders through annexation and client states.

Rubric — Explains links between mobilisation, multi-theatre warfare, and the creation of annexations/satellite states with specific examples.

Excellent (6 marks) (6 marks): Clearly explains how mass mobilisation (e.g. levée en masse/conscription) produced large armies, describes expansion into multiple theatres (gives at least two named theatres/campaigns), and links this military capacity to specific annexations or satellite states (at least two named examples such as the Batavian and Cisalpine Republics or Rhine annexations). Includes brief consideration of causation or competing interpretations (ideology vs strategy).

Good (4 marks) (4 marks): Explains that mobilisation created much larger armies and mentions expansion into multiple theatres, gives one or two examples of annexation or satellite states but with limited linkage or analysis of how mobilisation enabled them; may lack discussion of competing interpretations.

Limited (2 marks) (2 marks): Gives a basic statement that the Revolutionary Wars involved larger armies and some territorial gains or client states, but provides few or no specific examples and does not explain the connection between mobilisation and political changes.

Q14.

Answer: Faced with large-scale revolts and military conflicts in Saint-Domingue and other colonies, plus the need to secure colonial loyalty during wartime, the Convention decided to abolish slavery on 4 February 1794. The decision legally freed enslaved people in the colonies and extended full civil and political rights regardless of colour.

Rubric — Explanation of cause(s) and statement of the key change for people of colour.

Full (3 marks) (3 marks): Identifies the Convention's action as a response to revolts/military pressures in Saint-Domingue and other colonies AND clearly states that slavery was abolished and full rights/citizenship were extended to people regardless of colour.

Partial (2 marks) (2 marks): Mentions either the revolts/military pressure as a reason or that slavery was abolished and rights extended, but does not clearly link cause and effect or leaves one element vague.

Limited (1 mark) (1 marks): Gives a minimal fact such as 'slavery was abolished' or only mentions unrest in the colonies without explaining the outcome for people of colour.

Q15.

Correct: B. Women were active in early activism and organised societies, but the 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied them political rights and women's clubs were banned in October 1793.

A. Incorrect — this claims women were absent from early activism, but the historical record shows women did participate and organise societies before being excluded later.

B. Correct — it recognises that women were initially active and formed organisations, and that both the 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied political rights; women's clubs were banned in October 1793.

C. Incorrect — this reverses the outcome: women did not gain full political rights in 1791, and club activity was

restricted rather than expanded after 1793.

D. Incorrect — this overstates the 1793 reforms: women were not officially granted voting rights or formal recognition to participate in government; instead, political rights were denied and clubs were banned.

Q16.

Answer: After 1789 the Revolutionary government nationalised church lands and later properties of émigrés to secure state finances. To mobilise this wealth quickly it issued assignats — paper notes initially presented as certificates backed by confiscated land. Contemporary records show the assignats were intended both as government bonds and as currency to pay debts and military expenses. One interpretation is that assignats were a pragmatic short-term solution: they increased liquidity, allowed the government to meet obligations, and transferred property into the hands of new owners, supporting revolutionary goals.

However, from 1790–1796 the government issued ever larger quantities of assignats to cover chronic budget deficits. Historians point to over-issuance as the central cause of their collapse: as the supply of notes swelled beyond the value of available land, confidence fell, prices rose, and hyperinflation followed. Evidence for this includes rapidly rising price indices and contemporary complaints about falling real wages and market instability. Another interpretation emphasises structural pressures — war expenditure, tax collection failure, and political instability — arguing these forced excessive issuance and made any paper currency unreliable. Both views are compatible: over-issuance was the proximate cause, while fiscal and political weaknesses were underlying drivers.

The collapse had major economic and social effects. Economically it produced rampant inflation, disrupted commerce, and wiped out savings for many urban and rural households. Socially it fuelled hardship among the poor and anger among the middle classes who lost property value, contributing to unrest and undermining the Revolution's legitimacy in some areas. In sum, assignats began as a land-backed financing measure but, through over-issuance amid fiscal and political crisis, became a cause of severe economic dislocation with important social and political consequences.

Rubric — Explanation of creation and collapse of assignats, use of evidence, and assessment including competing interpretations

Comprehensive (6 marks) (6 marks): Explains how nationalisation led to assignats backed by confiscated land; clearly describes the process of over-issuance and links this to inflation and economic collapse. Uses specific evidence (e.g. rising prices, political/fiscal pressures) and presents at least one alternative interpretation (e.g. war and tax failure as underlying causes). Assesses economic and social consequences with clear causal links.

Partially complete (4 marks) (4 marks): Describes nationalisation and the basic idea of assignats and states that over-issuance led to loss of value and disruption. Provides some evidence or examples and mentions another factor (such as war or tax problems) but does not fully integrate interpretations or give a detailed assessment of consequences.

Limited (2 marks) (2 marks): Gives a brief statement that assignats were created from nationalised land and later failed, with minimal explanation or evidence. Consequences are mentioned in general terms without clear causal links or competing interpretations.

Q17.

Answer: 1) Financial crisis and state debt: France's involvement in costly wars (including support for the American Revolution) and long-term deficit spending left the monarchy unable to balance

the budget. Attempts to raise revenue and reform taxation met resistance from the privileged estates and parlements, producing a fiscal crisis that forced Louis XVI to call the Estates-General and exposed royal weakness. 2) Social inequality under the Estates system: French society was legally divided into three Estates, with the Third Estate (commoners) carrying the tax burden while lacking proportional political power. This entrenched economic and legal inequalities created widespread resentment and demands for representation and reform, turning fiscal strain into popular political mobilization.

Rubric — Clarity and accuracy in naming two causes and explaining how each contributed, grounded in the Britannica account.

Full marks (3 marks): Names two distinct causes and gives a clear, accurate sentence for each explaining how that cause contributed to the Revolution (both causes are connected to the fiscal/political crisis described by Britannica).

Partial credit (2 marks): Names only one cause with a correct explanation, or names two causes but provides only brief or very general explanations (shows partial linkage to how they contributed).

Minimal / no credit (0 marks): Fails to identify relevant causes or gives incorrect or irrelevant explanations that do not show how the causes contributed to the outbreak of the Revolution.

Q18.

Answer: The citation "Guillotine (Opie 1997)" tells the reader that the work being cited is a publication titled *Guillotine* authored by Robert Frederick Opie and published in 1997. It signals this is a secondary source (a book) that focuses specifically on the guillotine. A historian could use this citation in at least two ways: (1) as a synthesis of existing knowledge — by reading Opie's book the historian can learn established facts, chronology, and interpretations about the guillotine (for example, technical design changes, social reactions, or notable executions) and cite Opie when summarising that background; (2) as a source of primary-source leads and references — Opie's book will likely cite archival documents, contemporary newspapers, or official records; a historian can follow Opie's bibliography and footnotes to locate primary sources for their own analysis. Additionally, a historian should evaluate Opie's perspective and reliability by checking his cited sources, publication type, and whether later scholarship has challenged his conclusions. Using the book carefully means distinguishing Opie's interpretations from the original evidence he used.

Rubric — Understanding what the citation indicates and giving two concrete research uses with evaluation of reliability.

Full credit (6 marks): Clearly states that Opie (1997) is a book titled *Guillotine* by Robert Frederick Opie and that it is a secondary source. Provides two distinct, concrete ways a historian could use it (e.g. as synthesis/background; as a bibliography/lead to primary sources) and includes a brief comment on evaluating the source's reliability or perspective.

Partial credit (3 marks): Identifies the citation as a work by Opie (1997) and gives one clear way to use it or gives two uses but with limited specificity (e.g. vague phrases like "for information"). May mention evaluation briefly but without clear steps.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Shows minimal understanding (e.g. recognises Opie is an author/date) but offers no clear or relevant uses for research, or offers incorrect statements about the citation (e.g. calling it a primary source without justification).

Q19.

Answer: Two key long-term economic consequences identified by Acemoglu et al. (2011) are: (1) a weakening of old elite privileges and feudal constraints that led to more egalitarian local institutions and greater access to land and economic opportunity; and (2) improved provision of public goods and human-capital outcomes in areas that experienced radical reform, contributing

to higher long-run economic development. As evidence, the authors compare municipality-level outcomes across France using measures of revolutionary intensity (for example, the presence of Jacobin clubs, episodes of Terror, and records of confiscation/redistribution of church or noble lands) and apply econometric strategies (including controls and instrumental variable approaches exploiting geographic variation in revolutionary activity) to show that places with stronger radical intervention later had higher levels of public goods provision and better economic indicators.

Rubric — Identification of two consequences and description of one supporting piece of evidence from the paper.

Full marks (3 marks): Names two distinct long-term economic consequences attributed to radical reform (both consequences correctly linked to the Revolution) and describes one specific piece of evidence or empirical approach the authors use (e.g. municipality-level comparisons, measures of revolutionary intensity, or IV/geographic variation).

Partial credit (2 marks): Names one correct consequence and either names a second consequence weakly or imprecisely, and/or gives a vague or incomplete description of the evidence (mentions there is data/comparison but not the measures or empirical strategy).

Minimal/No credit (0 marks): Gives no correct consequences from the paper or only repeats very general claims without linking them to the authors' findings or evidence.

Q20.

Answer: Chisick shows that royalist pamphlets and periodicals such as the *Ami du Roi*, produced from Abbé Royou's offices, aimed to shape public opinion by mobilising readers through targeted messaging and by creating a networked distribution of print. First, they used clear, persuasive argument and moralising rhetoric to defend monarchy and religion, presenting the king as a guarantor of order and criticising revolutionary excesses. Second, they deployed selective reporting and satire: regular periodical formats (weekly essays, letters, and polemical pamphlets) repeated themes, attacked leading revolutionary figures, and used caricature and anecdote to make complex arguments accessible to literate urban readers. Chisick also emphasises the organisational tactics — centralised printing, paid contributors, and connections with provincial booksellers — which broadened reach beyond Paris. However, these royalist efforts faced important limitations: they competed in an expanding, crowded print market dominated increasingly by revolutionary voices; their social base was narrower (more aristocratic, clerical, and moderate bourgeois readers), and censorship or association with counter-revolution made distribution risky. Thus while royalist journalism tried to influence opinion through rhetorical clarity, regular publication, and distribution networks, its effectiveness was constrained by competition, limited audience, and political danger.

Rubric — Explanation of methods used by royalist pamphlets/periodicals (*Ami du Roi*/Abbé Royou) to influence opinion and one limitation.

Excellent (6 marks): Provides a clear, well-developed explanation that names at least two specific methods used by royalist publications (e.g. persuasive moral rhetoric; repeated periodical formats; satire/caricature; organised distribution through Royou's offices and bookseller networks) and gives one distinct limitation or challenge (e.g. competition from revolutionary press, narrow social base, censorship/risk). Evidence is explicitly tied to Chisick's analysis (mentions *Ami du Roi*/Abbé Royou and organisation) and shows understanding of how methods aimed to influence readers.

Satisfactory (4 marks): Identifies one clear method and at least one limitation, or names two methods in less detail. Refers to royalist press or *Ami du Roi*/Abbé Royou but with limited use of Chisick's specifics (for example mentions distribution or rhetoric but not organisational tactics). Explanation shows basic understanding of intent and a plausible limitation.

Limited (1 marks): Gives minimal or vague points: may state that royalist pamphlets tried to 'persuade people'

without specifying methods, or lists methods without linking them to influence. May omit reference to Ami du Roi/Abbé Royou or fail to give a real limitation. Response is fragmentary or largely descriptive with little understanding.

Q21.

Answer: Two major historiographical themes in the bibliography are: 1) social and class-based interpretations of the Revolution, and 2) cultural, political culture, and intellectual approaches.

1) Social and class-based interpretations — exemplar: Albert Soboul, *The French Revolution, 1787–1799* (or Soboul's work on the Sans-culottes and social classes). Soboul's work focuses on class structures, popular movements, and the role of the urban working classes (the sans-culottes) in driving the Revolution. This fits the social-history theme because it explains events in terms of socio-economic interests, class conflict, and collective action rather than solely elite politics. The bibliography's inclusion of Soboul indicates attention to Marxist-influenced and social causation explanations.

2) Cultural, political culture, and intellectual approaches — exemplar: Lynn Hunt, *Politics, Culture, and Class in the French Revolution* (or Hunt's writings on political culture and the public sphere). Hunt emphasizes language, symbols, public rituals, and changing mentalities, using cultural sources (pamphlets, festivals, petitions) to show how political meanings were constructed. This fits the cultural/intellectual theme by treating ideology, discourse, and practices as causal factors in revolutionary change rather than only structural social forces. Its presence in the bibliography signals interest in cultural analysis and interdisciplinary methods (literary, anthropological approaches) in interpreting the Revolution.

Together these examples show that the bibliography covers competing interpretations — structural class-based analyses and cultural/ideational approaches — and hence provides students with contrasting frameworks for understanding causes and dynamics of the French Revolution.

Rubric — Identification and explanation of historiographical themes with appropriate use of works from the bibliography.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly identifies two distinct historiographical themes; names one appropriate work (author and title) for each theme from the bibliography; explains with specific, relevant details from each work (its focus, sources or methods) how it exemplifies the theme and contrasts the interpretive approaches. Answer shows clear understanding of historiographical differences.

Satisfactory (3 marks): Identifies two themes and names a work for each, but explanations are general or omit specific evidence about the works' focus or methods. Shows basic understanding of differing approaches but with limited detail or minor imprecision.

Insufficient (0 marks): Identifies fewer than two clear themes, or names works without explaining how they relate to the themes; explanations are vague, incorrect, or unrelated to the historiographical approaches in the bibliography.

Q22.

Answer: 1. Population growth — evidence: the document names "population growth." Analysis: a long-term social and economic pressure that increased demand for food and strained resources, contributing to unrest. (1 mark)

2. Economic recession — evidence: the document lists "economic recession." Analysis: a short- to

medium-term economic cause that reduced incomes and increased hardship for urban workers and peasants. (1 mark)

3. Bad harvests — evidence: the document cites "bad harvests." Analysis: a short-term economic and social trigger that caused food shortages and raised bread prices, provoking immediate popular anger. (1 mark)

4. Tax complexity (and likely unfair taxation) — evidence: the document mentions "tax complexity." Analysis: a long-term financial and political problem that made revenue collection inefficient, increased burdens on the Third Estate, and fuelled resentment toward the fiscal system. (1 mark)

5. Resistance to reform — evidence: the document states "resistance to reform." Analysis: a political and institutional cause (long-term) showing that attempts to change taxation and governance were blocked by vested interests (nobility, clergy), producing constitutional crisis. (1 mark)

6. Enlightenment ideas — evidence: the document includes "Enlightenment ideas." Analysis: a long-term intellectual and political factor that changed political expectations about rights, sovereignty and legitimacy and helped justify revolutionary action. (1 mark)

Overall, the document identifies a mix of long-term structural causes (population growth, tax complexity, resistance to reform, Enlightenment ideas) and shorter-term economic shocks (recession, bad harvests) that together explain why revolution became possible and then immediate.

Rubric — Identifying multiple causes across social, economic, financial and political categories with cited evidence and classification as long- or short-term.

Full credit (6 marks): Identifies at least six distinct causes from the document (including social, economic, financial and political items), cites the specific wording of the document for each, and correctly classifies each as long-term or short-term with a brief analytic sentence linking the cause to revolutionary pressure.

Partial credit (3 marks): Identifies 3–5 correct causes from the document, cites the document wording for most of them, and gives at least a brief correct classification (long- or short-term) or explanation for some causes; may omit one category (e.g. political) or lack clarity in one or two analyses.

Minimal or no credit (0 marks): Identifies 0–2 causes or gives only vague/general statements without citing the document wording, and fails to classify causes clearly as long- or short-term or to link them to the outbreak of revolution.

Q23.

Answer: On 5 May 1789 the Estates General met at Versailles, summoned because of the fiscal crisis. Early debates revealed a dispute over voting procedures: the First and Second Estates wanted voting by order while the Third Estate demanded voting by head so it could have greater influence. Because the Estates General failed to resolve this dispute, the Third Estate moved to act independently. On 17 June 1789 the deputies of the Third Estate declared themselves the National Assembly, claiming they represented the nation and had the authority to make laws. Their declaration was a direct response to the stalemate over voting and the refusal of the privileged orders to accept common deliberation. When the King and some privileged deputies tried to prevent this break, the National Assembly found its meeting rooms closed and on 20 June 1789 the deputies assembled in a nearby indoor tennis court and took the Tennis Court Oath, vowing not to

separate until they had given France a constitution. Thus the sequence is: 5 May 1789 (Estates General convened and voting dispute became clear) continued deadlock 17 June 1789 (Third Estate proclaims the National Assembly) 20 June 1789 (Tennis Court Oath, which consolidated the break and commitment to constitutional reform).

Rubric — Chronological explanation linking dated actions to cause-and-effect leading from the Estates General to the National Assembly.

Full credit (6 marks): Accurately gives the sequence with at least three dated actions (including 5 May 1789 and 17 June 1789) and explains how each action caused the next (mentions voting dispute, declaration of the National Assembly, and the Tennis Court Oath or equivalent), showing clear causal links.

Partial credit (3 marks): Gives a correct but incomplete sequence (e.g. two dated actions such as 5 May and 17 June) or gives three dates but with weak or missing causal explanation; correctly identifies key events but omits one important dated action or causal link.

Minimal credit (0 marks): Provides only isolated facts or dates without a coherent sequence or causal links (e.g. mentions Estates General met in 1789 and that the Third Estate later formed the National Assembly but gives no dated actions or explanation of how one led to the other).

Q24.

Answer: The Reign of Terror was large in both scale and intensity. Between September 1793 and July 1794 around 300,000 people were arrested and about 16,600 officially executed for counter-revolutionary activity, showing systematic use of state arrest and capital punishment. Repressive mechanisms included legal instruments (revolutionary tribunals), mass arrests, and extra-judicial or semi-official violence such as the drownings at Nantes; the latter illustrate that repression took both formal and brutal local forms and that some death toll estimates remain contested by historians.

There are two main competing interpretations. One sees the Terror as driven by a revolutionary leadership convinced of existential threats: war, royalist plots and aristocratic resistance justified harsh centralised measures to defend the Republic. This interpretation emphasises central institutions (committees, tribunals) and the stated aim of protecting the revolution. The alternative interpretation stresses factional politics and power struggles within the revolution: the Terror became a tool for political actors to eliminate rivals, with local initiatives and rivalries contributing to violence. Evidence for this includes the contested death estimates and episodes of localized excess (e.g., Nantes) that suggest not all repression was centrally directed or universally supported.

Thermidor shows the political contingency: Robespierre lost support, was arrested after political isolation, wounded in an attempted suicide at the Hôtel de Ville, and executed on 28 July 1794 with colleagues. His fall supports the view that the Terror involved intense internal conflict, not unanimous revolutionary agreement. In sum, the Terror combined centralised institutions and legal repression with local violence and factional motives; historians should therefore combine both interpretations rather than treat the Terror as either purely defensive state policy or only elite power-struggles.

Rubric — Analysis of scale/mechanisms of repression and evaluation of competing historical interpretations, with reference to Thermidor and Robespierre.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly analyses the scale (uses figures: ~300,000 arrests; ~16,600 executed) and mechanisms (tribunals, mass arrests, drownings/local violence). Evaluates two competing interpretations (defensive revolutionary policy vs. factional power struggles), cites evidence for each, and explains how Thermidor and

Robespierre's arrest/execution support the conclusion that both central policy and internal conflict were important.

Satisfactory (3 marks): Describes the scale and some mechanisms of repression (gives at least one correct figure or example such as drownings at Nantes) and mentions two interpretations but offers limited evaluation or limited linkage to Thermidor/Robespierre. Analysis is present but lacks depth or specific evidence.

Limited (1 marks): Provides only brief or imprecise statements about repression (no figures or only vague reference), fails to compare or evaluate interpretations meaningfully, and does not connect events at Thermidor or Robespierre's fate to the explanations offered.